Minimally Invasive Orthopedic Surgery: Benefits and Recovery Time

In this blog post, you'll learn about minimally invasive orthopedic surgery procedures offered by Metro Healthcare Partners. You'll learn about the injuries it can treat, the procedures doctors use, and the benefits of smaller-incision surgery.

If you want to avoid the longer recovery, larger incisions, and more intense pain of open surgical procedures, contact Metro Healthcare Partners to schedule a consultation with an orthopedic doctor in Brooklyn, NY.

What Types of Injuries Can Be Treated With Minimally Invasive Orthopedic Surgery?

Minimally invasive surgical techniques use smaller incisions to treat many orthopedic conditions and reduce damage to surrounding tissue. The following sections describe some of the most common injuries that minimally invasive orthopedic surgery addresses.

Torn Ligaments and Tendons

Your ligaments and tendons help hold your joints together and control movement. When they tear, your joint can feel weak, unstable, and painful. Common injury examples include ACL tears, rotator cuff tears, and Achilles tendon tears.

Joint Damage and Advanced Arthritis

Your joint surfaces can wear down over time or suffer damage after an injury. When cartilage breaks down, your bones rub together and cause pain, stiffness, swelling, and reduced mobility. Common examples include knee arthritis, hip arthritis, shoulder arthritis, and post-traumatic arthritis that develops after a previous fracture or joint injury.

Fractures and Cartilage Injuries

Broken bones and damaged cartilage can limit your movement and create lasting pain when they don't heal correctly. Some fractures shift out of place or involve a joint surface, which can affect your long-term function. Cartilage injuries, such as meniscus tears in your knee or labral tears in your shoulder or hip, can also cause catching, grinding, swelling, and repeated pain during activity.

Minimally Invasive and Advanced Surgical Techniques Used by Orthopedic Doctors in Brooklyn

Minimally invasive orthopedic surgery uses smaller incisions, specialized instruments, and imaging technology to treat your injury while causing less disruption to the surrounding muscles, tendons, and soft tissue. The right procedure depends on the location of your injury, how severe the damage is, and your long-term mobility goals.

The following sections explain some of the most common minimally invasive orthopedic procedures performed by Metro Healthcare Partners.

Arthroscopic Joint Repair

Arthroscopy allows surgeons to examine and repair damage inside your joint through small incisions using a camera and specialized tools. Doctors often use this approach for torn ligaments, meniscus injuries, rotator cuff tears, cartilage damage, and chronic joint inflammation in your knee, shoulder, ankle, or hip.

Fracture Repair and Stabilization

Some broken bones need surgery to restore alignment and help your bones heal correctly. Surgeons may use plates, screws, rods, or pins to stabilize fractures caused by falls, sports injuries, work accidents, or car crashes. Proper repair can help reduce your long-term pain, stiffness, and loss of function.

Hip and Knee Replacement

When severe arthritis or major joint damage causes constant pain and limits your movement, hip or knee replacement may become the best option. Surgeons remove the damaged joint surfaces and replace them with artificial components that restore smoother movement. Depending on your condition, your surgeon may use a traditional or minimally invasive approach.

The Benefits of Minimally Invasive Orthopedic Procedures

At Metro Healthcare Partners, we offer both traditional and minimally invasive surgery, but we always recommend minimally invasive orthopedic surgery whenever your condition allows it. The following sections describe four reasons to choose minimally invasive orthopedic surgery when you have it as an option.

Smaller Incisions

Minimally invasive procedures use smaller incisions than many traditional surgeries. Smaller openings usually create less visible scarring and reduce trauma to the surrounding muscles, tendons, and soft tissue.

Faster Recovery Time

According to Yale Medicine, minimally invasive surgery causes less tissue damage, pain, and scarring and leads to fewer complications, which helps many patients recover quickly, leave the hospital sooner, and in some cases shorten their recovery from weeks to just days.

Reduced Postoperative Pain

Less disruption to the surrounding tissue often means less pain after surgery. Lower pain levels can make it easier for you to walk, complete physical therapy, and move through recovery with fewer setbacks.

Outpatient Options

According to a study published on ScienceDirect, the share of procedures performed on an outpatient basis increased from 68.9% to 85.4% between 2011 and 2018 as surgical techniques improved and recovery times shortened. Many minimally invasive orthopedic treatments use outpatient surgical procedures that let you return home the same day, avoid an overnight hospital stay, and begin recovery in a more comfortable setting.

Schedule a Minimally Invasive Surgery Consultation With an Orthopedic Doctor in Brooklyn

In this blog post, you learned about minimally invasive orthopedic surgery, including the conditions it treats, common procedures, recovery time, and key benefits. Stop putting off surgery because you don't want to deal with large incisions, more pain, and a longer recovery. With minimally invasive surgery options from Metro Healthcare Partners, you have a safer and easier path to recovery.

Our doctors accept most insurance plans, including workers' compensation, no-fault, and PIP (personal injury protection). Same-day appointments may be available, so call Metro Healthcare Partners to schedule your visit today.

Frequently Asked Questions

Is Minimally Invasive Surgery More Expensive?

It depends. While some minimally invasive procedures cost more initially, research indexed on PubMed found that they often result in lower total costs than open surgery due to reduced hospital and recovery expenses.

Is Minimally Invasive Surgery Safer?

Often, yes. Smaller incisions reduce blood loss and the risk of infection, and they usually mean less pain and a shorter recovery.

How Long Does It Take To Recover From Minimally Invasive Hip Replacement Surgery?

Many patients begin walking the same or the next day, resume light daily activities within 3 to 6 weeks, and continue improving until fully healed.